

Absolutely — **one** is an excellent grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage actually uses the plural substitute form **ones**:

> “...and some smaller **ones** are kept on a sunny balcony just outside her kitchen.”

Here **ones** does **not** mean the number “1”. It replaces the already-mentioned plural noun **plants**, so that English does not repeat **plants**.

Word family: **one / ones**

Base form: one

Plural substitute form: ones

Part of speech: numeral/determiner (數詞 / 限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞)

Useful patterns: one of, the one, this one, ones, one...the other, one another, one by one, one at a time

This is mainly a **grammar/polyfunctionality word**, rather than a large lexical word family.

Meaning in your passage: **ones** = substitute for a previously mentioned plural countable noun
— 那些..... / 幾個.....

Your sentence:

> “Most of these plants are grown on the rooftop of her house, and some smaller **ones** are kept on a sunny balcony...”

Here:

> **ones** = plants

The writer avoids repeating:

> some smaller plants

and instead says:

> some smaller ones

繁體中文：

用來代替前面已提到的複數可數名詞，避免重複

Natural translation:

> “...some smaller ones are kept on a sunny balcony...”

「而一些**較小的植物**則放在廚房外陽光充足的露台上。」

So here:

> **ones = 前文提到的 plants**

1. **one = number 1 (一) — 一 ; 一個**

The basic numeral meaning.

Practice 1

> “She has **one** lemon tree.”

「她有**一棵**檸檬樹。」

Practice 2

> “I only need one pot.”

「我只需要**一個**花盆。」

one = 數字 1 , 表示單一的人、物或單位

2. **one + singular countable noun (一個 / 一位) — 一個 ; 一位 ; 一件**

Here **one** functions before a noun.

Practice 3

> “Choose **one plant** for the balcony.”

「選**一棵植物**放在露台。」

Practice 4

> “Only one student knew the answer.”

「只有**一名學生**知道答案。」

one + singular countable noun = 數量為一的某個人 / 事物

3. **one = a single unspecified person/thing — 一個；某一個**

A pronoun use.

Practice 5

> “I need a pot. Can you give me **one**?”

「我需要一個花盆，你可以給我**一個**嗎？」

Practice 6

> “She wanted a lemon, so I gave her one.”

「她想要一個檸檬，所以我給了她**一個**。」

one = 代替前面已知的單數可數名詞，表示同類中的一個

Here:

> one = one pot / one lemon

4. **one / ones = substitute noun after an adjective —的那一個 / 那些**

This is the key grammar use behind your source.

Practice 7

> “I like the red pot, not the blue **one**.”

「我喜歡紅色的花盆，不喜歡藍色的**那一個**。」

Practice 8

> “The small plants need less space than the large **ones**.”

「小型植物比大型的**那些植物**需要較少空間。」

one/ones = 在形容詞或其他修飾語後代替前面已知的可數名詞

Singular:

> the red **one**

Plural:

> the red **ones**

5. **ones** = plural substitute for previously mentioned countable nouns — 那些；那些.....

This is your exact source use.

Practice 9 — Original

> “Some smaller **ones** are kept on a sunny balcony.”

「一些較小的植物放在陽光充足的露台上。」

Practice 10

> “The healthy plants are outside, and the weaker **ones** are indoors.”

「健康的植物放在外面，較弱的**那些植物**則放在室內。」

Practice 11

> “I prefer the small tomatoes to the large **ones**.”

「比起大番茄，我較喜歡小的**那些番茄**。」

ones = 代替前面已提過的複數可數名詞，避免重複

6. **the one** = the particular person/thing — 那個；那一個

Practice 12

> “This is **the one** I want.”

「這就是我想要的**那一個**。」

Practice 13

> “Which plant is yours?”

> “The one by the window.”

「哪棵植物是你的？」

「窗邊的**那一棵**。」

****the one = 在幾個可能對象中，指特定的那一個****

7. ****this one / that one / these ones / those ones — 這個 / 那個 / 這些 / 那些****

Practice 14

> “I prefer ****this one****.”

「我比較喜歡****這一個****。」

Practice 15

> “Those ones need more sunlight.”

「****那些****需要更多陽光。」

****one/ones = 可跟指示詞配合，代替已知名詞****

Usage note:

* ****this one / that one**** very common

* ****these ones / those ones**** possible, especially conversationally, though simply ****these/those**** is often more concise.

8. ****one of + plural noun/pronoun (其中之一) —之一****

A major construction.

Practice 16

> “This is ****one of my favourite plants****.”

「這是最喜歡的植物****之一****。」

Practice 17

> “One of them is a lemon tree.”

「它們**其中一棵**是檸檬樹。」

one of + plural noun/pronoun = 一組人 / 事物中的其中一個

Important grammar:

> one of the plants **is** healthy. 

Main subject is **one**, so singular verb is standard.

9. **one of the + superlative + plural noun — 最.....之一**

A very important academic/general pattern.

Practice 18

> “Roses are **one of the most popular flowers**.”

「玫瑰是**最受歡迎的花卉之一**。」

Practice 19

> “This is one of the easiest plants to grow.”

「這是**最容易種植的植物之一**。」

one of the + superlative + plural noun = 某群體中屬於最高程度的一員

Important:

> one of the best **books** 

> *one of the best book* 

The noun after **one of the** is plural.

10. **one = a person in general (正式) — 人；一個人；任何人**

A distinct formal pronoun use.

Practice 20

> “**One** should always check the instructions.”

「**人們 / 一個人**應該先查看指示。」

Practice 21

> “One never knows what might happen.”

「**誰也說不準**會發生甚麼事。」

one — formal pronoun = 泛指任何人 / 一般人，而不是某個特定的人

Register:

- * formal
- * impersonal
- * more common in careful written English

Everyday speech usually prefers:

> you

11. **one's = belonging to oneself / a person in general — 自己的；一個人的**

Related to formal **one**.

Practice 22

> “One should take care of **one's** health.”

「一個人應該照顧**自己的**健康。」

Practice 23

> “It is important to know one's limits.”

「了解**自己的**極限很重要。」

one's = 與泛指 one 對應的所有格形式

Formal pattern:

> one → one's → oneself

12. **oneself = oneself in general — 自己；自身**

Practice 24

> “One should give **oneself** enough time to rest.”

「一個人應該給**自己**足夠時間休息。」

Practice 25

> “It is important to be honest with oneself.”

「對**自己**誠實很重要。」

oneself = formal generic reflexive form corresponding to one

13. **one...the other (兩者) — 一個.....另一個.....**

A major two-item pattern.

Practice 26

> “There are two pots: **one** is blue and **the other** is green.”

「有兩個花盆：**一個**是藍色，**另一個**是綠色。」

Practice 27

> “One plant is healthy, but the other needs more water.”

「**一棵**植物很健康，但**另一棵**需要更多水。」

one...the other = 已知只有兩個人 / 物時，一個.....另一個.....

14. **one...another (多個中的另一個) — 一個.....另一個.....**

Practice 28

> “One customer left, and **another** arrived.”

「一位顧客離開後，**另一位**來了。」

Practice 29

> “She moved one pot and picked up another.”

「她移走一個花盆，又拿起了**另一個**。」

one...another = 在不只兩個可能對象中，一個.....另一個.....

Important contrast:

* exactly two → **the other**

* more than two / unspecified → **another**

15. **one another** = each other — 彼此；互相

A fixed reciprocal pronoun.

Practice 30

> “Neighbours help **one another**.”

「鄰居之間會**互相幫助**。」

Practice 31

> “The plants compete with one another for light.”

「植物之間會為陽光**互相競爭**。」

one another = 兩個或以上的人 / 事物彼此做某事

In modern English, **one another** and **each other** overlap heavily.

16. **one by one** = one after another — 一個接一個；逐一

Practice 32

> “She checked the plants **one by one**.”

「她把植物**逐一**檢查。」

Practice 33

> “The lights went out one by one.”

「燈**一盞接一盞**地熄滅。」

one by one = 每次一個，逐個進行

17. **one at a time = only one at each moment — 每次一個；一次一個**

Practice 34

> “Carry the pots **one at a time**.”

「花盆要**每次搬一個**。」

Practice 35

> “Please speak one at a time.”

「請**一次一個人**說話。」

one at a time = 同一時間只處理 / 進行一個

18. **one after another = repeatedly / in sequence — 一個接一個**

Practice 36

> “Problems appeared **one after another**.”

「問題**一個接一個**地出現。」

Practice 37

> “Guests arrived one after another.”

「客人**接二連三**到達。」

one after another = 多個人 / 事情按次序接連發生

Compared with **one by one**, this often emphasizes succession rather than careful individual handling.

19. **one and the same** = exactly the same — 完全相同；同一個

Practice 38

> “The two names refer to **one and the same person**.”

「這兩個名字其實指**同一個人**。」

Practice 39

> “These are **one and the same issue**.”

「這兩件事其實是**同一個問題**。」

one and the same = 表面可能不同，但實際上完全是同一人 / 物 / 事情

20. **one or two** = a small number / a few — 一兩個；少數

Practice 40

> “I have **one or two questions**.”

「我有**一兩個問題 / 幾個小問題**。」

Practice 41

> “One or two plants need extra care.”

「有**一兩棵植物**需要額外照料。」

one or two = 字面一個或兩個；口語中亦可泛指很少數的幾個

21. **one day** = on a particular day / someday — 有一天；某一天

A common pattern with two readings.

Past narrative

> “**One day**, she decided to start a garden.”

「**有一天**，她決定開始種植。」

Future

> “I hope to have my own garden **one day**.”

「我希望**有朝一日**有自己的花園。」

one day = 某一天；依時態可指過去某日或未來有一天

22. **one time = once / on one occasion — 一次；某一次**

Practice 42

> “I met her **one time** at a garden show.”

「我曾在園藝展上見過她**一次**。」

Practice 43

> “At one time, the rooftop was completely empty.”

「**曾經有一段時間**，天台完全是空的。」

Note:

* **one time** = 一次

* **at one time** = 曾經 / 一度；有時也指同一時間

23. **one = unity / single whole (抽象) — 一體；一個整體**

A less common but established abstract use.

Practice 44

> “The two teams worked as **one**.”

「兩個團隊像**一個整體**般合作。」

Practice 45

> “The community came together as one.”

「社區團結成**一體**。」

as one = 像一個整體般一致、團結地

24. **be at one with + person/nature (和諧一致) — 與.....融為一體；和諧一致**

A literary/fixed expression worth flagging.

Practice 46

> “She feels **at one with nature** when gardening.”

「做園藝時，她感到自己**與大自然融為一體**。」

Practice 47

> “For a moment, he felt at one with his surroundings.”

「那一刻，他感到自己與周遭環境**完全和諧融合**。」

be at one with = 與某人 / 某物完全和諧、沒有隔閡

Register: somewhat literary.

Important distinction: **one vs a/an**

Both can indicate a single countable item, but emphasis differs.

a/an

normally simply introduces one non-specific item.

> “She has a lemon tree.”

one

specifically emphasizes quantity = exactly one.

> “She has one lemon tree, not two.”

So:

> a plant = 一棵植物

> one plant = 一棵 (強調數量是一)

Important distinction: **one** vs **it**

This is crucial.

it

refers to the **same specific object**.

> “I bought a pot and painted **it**.”

= 我買了一個花盆，然後把**那同一個花盆**上色。

one

means another item of the same type / one fitting the description.

> “I need a pot. I’ll buy **one**.”

= 我需要一個花盆，我會買**一個**。

So:

> **it** = 同一件東西

> **one** = 同類中的一個

Important distinction: **one** vs **ones**

one

replaces a singular countable noun.

> “the small one”

= 小的那一個

ones

replaces a plural countable noun.

> “the small ones”

= 小的那些

Your source has:

> **some smaller ones**

because **plants** is plural.

Important distinction: **one/ones cannot normally replace uncountable nouns**

We can say:

> “I like the red pot, not the blue one.”

But not normally:

> *I prefer fresh water to dirty one.* ❌

Because **water** is uncountable.

Instead:

> “I prefer fresh water to dirty water.”

or restructure the sentence.

So **one/ones as noun substitutes are mainly for countable nouns**.

Important distinction: **one vs the one**

one

= an unspecified one.

> “I need one.”

= 我需要一个。

the one

= the specific one identified by context.

> “That is the one I need.”

= 那就是我需要的那一个。

Important distinction: **one of vs one**

one plant

= 一棵植物

one of the plants

= 那些植物中的一棵

one of explicitly selects one member from a larger group.

Important distinction: **one of + plural noun**

Correct:

> one of my favourite **books** 

Not:

> *one of my favourite book* 

Because the larger group contains multiple books.

Important distinction: **one of them is vs one of them are**

The grammatical subject is singular **one**:

> “One of them **is** ready.” 

Not:

> *One of them are ready.* ❌

This is a common learner trap.

Important distinction: **one...the other vs one...another**

Exactly two:

> “One is red; **the other** is blue.”

More than two / indefinite:

> “One is red; **another** is blue.”

So:

> the other = 剩下的那一個

> another = 另一個，並不一定是最後一個

Important distinction: **one another vs another one**

Completely different.

one another

= 彼此

> “They help one another.”

another one

= 另一個

> “I need another one.”

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: ****one by one vs one at a time****

****one by one****

emphasizes sequence:

> “The flowers opened one by one.”

= 花一朵一朵地開。

****one at a time****

emphasizes only one simultaneously:

> “Carry one pot at a time.”

= 每次只搬一個花盆。

Important distinction: ****one = generic person vs you****

Formal:

> “One should be careful.”

Everyday:

> “You should be careful.”

Both can mean general people, but ****one**** is more formal and impersonal.

Important distinction: ****one vs once****

****one****

= 一 ; 一個

****once****

= 一次 / 曾經

> one visit

> = 一次探訪

> I visited once
> = 我去過一次

They are related historically/semantically, but grammatically different.

Grammar note: possessive and reflexive forms

Generic ****one**** has its own formal paradigm:

> ****one**** → 一個人 / 人
> ****one's**** → 自己的
> ****oneself**** → 自己

Example:

> “One should know one’s own limits.”

「人應該了解自己的極限。」

Avoid mixing formal styles carelessly:

> “One should know your limits.”

is stylistically inconsistent in careful formal writing.

Family / pattern sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory is:

* ****one — number**** = 一
* ****one + singular noun**** = 一個 / 一位
* ****one — substitute pronoun**** = 同類中的一個
* ****one/ones after adjective**** =的那一個 / 那些
* ****ones — plural substitute**** = 那些.....
* ****the one**** = 特定的那一個
* ****this/that one**** = 這個 / 那個
* ****one of**** =之一
* ****one of the + superlative**** = 最.....之一
* ****one — generic person**** = 人 / 一般人
* ****one's**** = 自己的
* ****oneself**** = 自己

* **one...the other** = 一個.....另一個
 * **one...another** = 一個.....另一個
 * **one another** = 彼此
 * **one by one** = 逐一
 * **one at a time** = 每次一個
 * **one after another** = 一個接一個
 * **one and the same** = 完全是同一個
 * **one or two** = 一兩個
 * **one day** = 有一天 / 有朝一日
 * **as one** = 一體 / 一致
 * **at one with** = 與.....融為一體 / 和諧一致

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
one — numeral	數字 1；表示單一的人、物或單位
one + singular noun	表示數量為一的某個可數人 / 事物
one — substitute pronoun	代替已提及的單數可數名詞，表示同類中的一個
one/ones after adjective	用形容詞區分已知名詞時，代替該單數 / 複數可數名詞
ones	代替前面已提及的複數可數名詞，避免重複
the one	幾個可能對象中特定的那一個
one of + plural noun	某一群體中的其中一個
one of the + superlative	某群體中屬於最高程度的一員；最.....之一
one — generic person	正式泛指任何人 / 一般人
one's	與泛指 one 對應的所有格；自己的
oneself	與泛指 one 對應的反身代名詞；自己
one...the other	在恰好兩者中，一個.....剩下另一個.....
one...another	在多於兩個 / 數量未定的群體中，一個.....另一個.....
one another	兩個或以上的人 / 事物彼此做某事
one by one	每次逐個、按順序一個接一個
one at a time	同一時間只處理 / 進行一個
one after another	多件事情接連、依次發生
one and the same	看似不同但實際是完全同一人 / 物 / 事情
one or two	一兩個；少數幾個
one day	過去某一天或未來有朝一日
as one	像一個整體一樣一致 / 團結
at one with	與某人、自然或環境處於完全和諧一致的狀態

For your original sentence

> “Most of these plants are grown on the rooftop of her house, and some smaller **ones** are kept on a sunny balcony...”

The exact meaning is:

****ones** = 代替前面已經出現的複數名詞 plants，意思就是「較小的那些植物」******

Expanded sentence:

> “...and some smaller ****plants**** are kept on a sunny balcony.”

So naturally:

> ******「這些植物大多種在她家的天台上，而一些較小的植物則放在廚房外陽光充足的露台上。」******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****one plant**** → 一棵植物
- > ****one**** → 同類中的一個
- > ****the small one**** → 小的那一個
- > ****the small ones**** → 小的那些
- > ****one of the plants**** → 植物中的一棵
- > ****one...the other**** → 一個.....另一個（共兩個）
- > ****one...another**** → 一個.....另一個（不只兩個）
- > ****one another**** → 彼此
- > ****one by one**** → 逐一
- > ****one at a time**** → 每次一個